



The Automate-By-Friday Checklist

18 everyday tasks most small businesses are still doing by hand —
and what it looks like the moment an AI agent quietly takes over.

● ● ●

```
$ scanning daily operations...  
> checking sales, support, scheduling, admin, marketing  
> manual tasks found: 18  
> estimated hours/week lost to repetition: high  
> recommendation: automate ✓
```

Most businesses aren't understaffed. They're under-automated.

Every business has a running list of tasks nobody loves doing, but everybody keeps doing anyway: answering the same questions, chasing the same follow-ups, retyping the same information from one place to another. None of it takes a person's judgment. All of it takes a person's time.

The businesses pulling ahead right now aren't necessarily working harder or hiring faster — **they've quietly handed the repetitive parts of their day to an AI agent:** software that handles a task start to finish, the same way every time, at any hour, without needing to be reminded, trained, or managed.

This guide is a simple, honest audit. The next few pages list 18 common tasks across sales, support, scheduling, admin, and marketing. Go through them and tick the box for anything your business is still doing by hand today. By the end, you'll have a clear picture of exactly where your team's time is going — and where it doesn't have to.

// HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

- 1 Check the box next to anything you or your team still do *manually* today.
- 2 Don't overthink it — if it's even partly manual, check it.
- 3 Add up your checkmarks and read your result on the last checklist page.

01

Sales & Lead
Response

02

Customer
Support

03

Scheduling &
Operations

04

Admin & Back
Office

05

Marketing &
Retention



01 Sales & Lead Response

4 items

- ☐ **New website inquiries sit in an inbox until someone's free**
Every minute between "they reached out" and "someone replied" is a minute a competitor could get there first.
- ☐ **The same qualifying questions get asked manually, every time**
Budget, timeline, needs — typed out (or said out loud) one lead at a time, by a person.
- ☐ **Leads who don't convert immediately rarely hear from you again**
No consistent follow-up sequence means warm leads quietly go cold — and nobody notices until they've already booked with someone else.
- ☐ **Pricing and quote info gets typed out fresh for every inquiry**
Even when the answer is basically the same every time, someone still has to write it out.

02 Customer Support

4 items

- ☐ **The same FAQs get answered over and over**
Hours, location, pricing, policies — questions your team could recite in their sleep, asked again by someone new every day.
- ☐ **"Where's my order / appointment?" calls tie up staff time**
A two-minute status check interrupts whatever your team was actually trying to focus on.
- ☐ **Simple support requests wait in the same queue as everything else**
A password reset and a serious complaint both land in the same inbox, with the same "we'll get to it."
- ☐ **Anything that comes in after hours waits until tomorrow**
Including the customer who was ready to buy, book, or sign tonight.

// WHAT THIS LOOKS LIKE WITH AN AGENT

A **Lead Qualification Agent** replies to new inquiries in seconds, asks your standard questions, and only routes the leads that are ready to talk — straight to your inbox.

A **Customer Support Agent** handles FAQs, order status, and basic requests around the clock — 24/7, every day — and escalates anything it can't resolve to your team.



03 Scheduling & Operations

4 items

- ☐ **Booking a call or appointment takes several back-and-forth messages**
"Does Tuesday work?" "What time?" "Actually, can we do Thursday instead?" — a five-message thread for one booking.
- ☐ **No-shows happen because reminders are inconsistent**
Or don't go out at all — and the slot just sits empty.
- ☐ **Reschedules and cancellations are handled one at a time, manually**
Each one becomes its own little fire to put out, in between everything else.
- ☐ **Staff cross-check multiple calendars just to confirm availability**
Before anyone can even answer "are you free Thursday?"

04 Admin & Back Office

3 items

- ☐ **Invoices and payment reminders go out manually — and sometimes late**
Nobody loves chasing payments, so it's the first thing that slips when the week gets busy.
- ☐ **New client information gets typed in by hand**
From a form, an email, or a phone call into whatever system actually runs the business.
- ☐ **CRM records get updated "when there's time"**
Which, realistically, means they're usually a few weeks out of date.

// WHAT THIS LOOKS LIKE WITH AN AGENT

A **Booking & Scheduling Agent** lets clients self-book, reschedule, and get reminders — synced to your real calendar, with zero back-and-forth.

The same agent can quietly update your CRM and trigger an invoice the moment a job or appointment is marked complete — no extra typing required.



05

Marketing & Retention

3 items

☐

Review requests are an afterthought — or skipped entirely

Happy customers rarely leave a review unless someone asks, at the right moment, every time.

☐

Past customers go quiet because no one follows up

They liked working with you. They just haven't thought about you since.

☐

Recap notes and follow-ups after calls get written from scratch

Every single time — same structure, same effort, different name at the top.

Add up your checkmarks

There's no wrong score here — just a clearer picture of where your team's hours are actually going each week.

0-5

CHECKED

You're leaner than most

Your operations are tighter than average — but the few items you checked are still worth a closer look, since they tend to be the ones that quietly eat the most time.

6-11

CHECKED

Your team is spending real hours on work that doesn't need a person

This is the most common range. Individually, each task feels small — together, they add up to a meaningful chunk of every week that could go toward growth instead of repetition.

12-18

CHECKED

Your business is running a second, unpaid employee — made of busywork

This is exactly the kind of operation an AI agent is built for: well-defined, repetitive, and currently soaking up hours that could be spent on customers, sales, or simply going home on time.



Whatever you checked, an AI agent can probably take it off your plate.

You don't need to figure out the tech, hire a developer, or manage another piece of software. Tell us which boxes you checked — we design, build, and run the agent for you.

01**Tell us what you checked**

A quick call to walk through your list — in plain language, no specs needed.

02**We build your agent**

Our team designs, configures, and connects it to the tools you already use.

03**You go live — we host it**

Fully deployed and monitored on our infrastructure. You just watch it work.

// SIMPLE PRICING

Most businesses start with **one AI agent workflow** covering a single category from this checklist.

\$600/mo per agent
hosting, monitoring & updates included
+ \$1,000 one-time setup
design, build & deployment

[Book a free 20-minute call →](#)

Free 20-minute call · No commitment
Live in days if it's a fit
talktomedata.com/book-demo

